10. Less, editors, and reading large output

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Phase: Phase 3 — Text, pipes, and discovery
Estimated time: 1 day
Slug: `10-editors-paging`

Learning objectives

- Page output with less/more
- Edit files in nano or vim at a basic level
- Search inside less
- Avoid opening multi-GB logs in a GUI editor

Prerequisites

Complete prior numbered lessons. Prefer a real Linux VM/container for Linux-specific topics.

less

```
less huge.log
# /pattern  search
# n next, q quit, F follow (like tail -f)
```

Editors

Learn **enough** vim or stick with nano while learning Linux:

```
nano file.txt
vim file.txt   # :wq save+quit, :q! discard
```

For infra work, vim/emacs fluency pays off over years — but do not block learning shell on editor mastery.

Common mistakes

- cat-ing multi-GB files to the terminal
- Getting stuck in vim without knowing `:q!`
- Editing production configs without backups

Exercises

Work in `exercises/10-editors-paging/`. Run:

```
./test.sh
```

- **A (Drill):** make `./test.sh` pass
- **B (Apply):** note one real command you ran on a Linux host related to this lesson
- **C (Challenge):** rewrite your solution from memory the next day

Do not open `solutions/10-editors-paging/` until you have an honest failing attempt.

Self-check

1. How search in less?
2. How quit vim without saving?
3. Why page instead of cat?

Further reading

- https://www.vim.org/